

S04-05 - Toward Open Vale

Player read-aloud

The Custodian closes the crate with both hands. "We must go to Open Vale. The magic will draw things best left uninvited."

Scene summary

The Custodian insists the Keystone must be renewed at Open Vale? Ritual Site.

Visible choices

- Travel immediately
- Prepare first
- Question the danger

Player questions

- What detail in Toward Open Vale tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

GM notes

- Skip or montage if time is short.
- Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it.
- Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.

Checks and rolls

- Instinct or Knowledge Choose approach and prepare for the ritual site. Standard Place the party well for Act Five. 15 Cleanly resolve: Choose approach and prepare for the ritual site. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Toward Open Vale. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.

Clues

- Open Vale pull The site is near. The ward has a memory of its own. The Keystone

physically wants the ritual site.

Loot

- Approach advantage
- One preparation detail each player names
- Whitefire Custodian's Ward-Charm: A small hand-carved wooden ratcoon mid-scamper has been thumb-worn smooth for luck. It is warm, and the forest feels a little kinder while you hold it.

Mechanics

- Plot So Far: The party is in Act Four pressure: The Custodian insists the Keystone must be renewed at Open Vale? Ritual Site.
- Mechanics In Play: Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting.
- Roll Cards: s04-05-carry-the-keystone-through-the-dark-path S04-05 Carry the Keystone through the dark path Carry the Keystone through the dark path Strength Agility Strength Agility 12 Strength bears weight; Agility moves safely with it. The asset becomes a burden at the worst moment. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The asset becomes a burden at...
- Gm Fear Spends: Make neglected infrastructure answer at the wrong moment. Stress the Custodian's trust without turning her into a device.
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Escalation: Escalate by making cost visible: time, noise, trust, ward instability, or someone vulnerable in danger.
- Deescalation: De-escalate through respect, care, honest testimony, useful evidence, or a concrete concession.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Toward Open Vale asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Instinct, Presence, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Class Community Ancestry Reveals: Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes,

and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

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